

SenseTime (0020.HK): 1H26 net profit beat; AI model upgrade to drive client adoption; Neutral

Sensetime announced 1H26 net profit guidance at Rmb500m to Rmb700m ([Link](#)), turning profitable from 1H25 net loss of Rmb1.5bn loss, beating our previous estimates of Rmb893m loss. The adjusted net loss is guided to reduce 60%~70% YoY in 1H26. Management attributes it to (1) improving operational efficiency on cost management and higher productivity, and (2) higher-than-expected non-OP gains. As the AI supplier with comprehensive solutions across computing power, AI models, AI applications, we see the company continuing to expand its Gen-AI product coverage, focusing on the cost reduction and ROI to achieve better profitability. Maintain Neutral.

Upgraded Multi-modal AI model: Sensetime has released the SenseNova token plan from July 2026 to charge users by the token usage, and newly includes the SenseNova 6.8 Flash Lite Preview model, featuring (1) capabilities to process long context; (2) dynamic collaboration of sub-agents; and (3) multi-modal integration across documents, text, chart and video. We see the company's AI model is migrating to the "Delegated Intelligence", enabling AI to complete the process and users to focus on the delivery of the AI output for large-scale commercialization.

Earnings revision: We factor in Sensetime 1H26 profit guidance, and revise up 2026/ 27E net loss to Rmb59m/ Rmb336m (vs. previously at Rmb1.25bn/ Rmb357m net loss in 2026/ 27E), and revise up 2028-32E earnings by 13%/ 5%/ 2%/ 2%/ 1%. We keep revenues and GM largely unchanged, and revise down Opex ratio to reflect company's improving productivity and cost saving.

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Exhibit 1: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E			2029E			2030E			2031E			2032E		
	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %
Revenues	6,503	6,527	0%	8,359	8,386	0%	9,380	9,408	0%	11,210	11,241	0%	13,377	13,411	0%	15,263	15,302	0%	17,133	17,176	0%
GP	2,521	2,531	0%	3,287	3,298	0%	3,776	3,788	0%	4,608	4,621	0%	5,660	5,675	0%	6,480	6,497	0%	7,296	7,315	0%
OP	(1,481)	(1,567)	na	(553)	(557)	na	122	127	5%	771	792	3%	1,663	1,684	1%	2,372	2,394	1%	3,119	3,142	1%
Net income	(1,253)	(59)	na	(357)	(336)	na	308	348	13%	914	961	5%	1,742	1,780	2%	2,447	2,487	2%	3,219	3,261	1%
Margins																					
GM	38.8%	38.8%		39.3%	39.3%		40.3%	40.3%		41.1%	41.1%		42.3%	42.3%		42.5%	42.5%		42.6%	42.6%	
OPM	-22.8%	-24.0%		-6.6%	-6.6%		1.3%	1.4%		6.9%	7.0%		12.4%	12.6%		15.5%	15.6%		18.2%	18.3%	
NM	-19.3%	-0.9%		-4.3%	-4.0%		3.3%	3.7%		8.2%	8.6%		13.0%	13.3%		16.0%	16.3%		18.8%	19.0%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

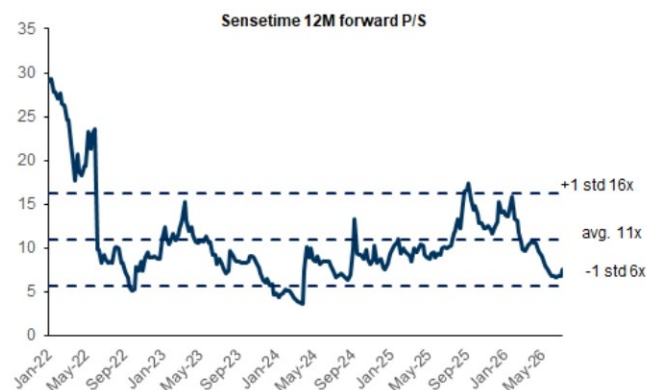
Valuation: Our valuation methodology remains unchanged. Our DCF value per share is HK\$2.05 (vs. previously at HK\$2.00) based on higher FCF and WACC at 11.5% (vs. previously at 11.6%, with cost of debt updated to 4.3% vs. previously at 5.7%), and terminal growth rate at 2% (unchanged). The share price currently trades at 7.0x 2027E P/S, largely in line with our TP implied 2027E P/S at 9.6x, suggesting the positives are largely in the price.

Exhibit 2: Sensetime DCF valuation

Rmb mn	Stage 1												Stage 2									
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E	2033E	2034E	2035E	2036E	2037E	2038E	2039E	2040E	2041E	
P&L																						
Revenue	4,700	3,809	3,406	3,772	5,015	6,527	8,386	9,408	11,241	13,411	15,302	17,176										
YoY	36%	-19%	-11%	11%	33%	30%	28%	12%	19%	19%	14%	12%										
Opex ratio	140.3%	170.2%	170.2%	165.7%	111.1%	62.8%	46.0%	38.9%	34.1%	29.8%	26.8%	24.3%										
OP income	(3,316)	(3,941)	(4,295)	(4,630)	(3,514)	(1,567)	(557)	127	792	1,684	2,394	3,142										
YoY	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	522%	113%	42%	31%										
Pretax income	(17,142)	(6,333)	(6,504)	(4,300)	(1,660)	(68)	(345)	348	973	1,827	2,564	3,362										
Net income	(17,140)	(6,045)	(6,440)	(4,278)	(1,766)	(59)	(336)	348	961	1,780	2,487	3,261										
YoY	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	176%	85%	40%	31%										
GPM	69.7%	66.8%	44.1%	42.9%	41.0%	38.8%	39.3%	40.3%	41.1%	42.3%	42.5%	42.6%										
OPM	-70.6%	-103.5%	-126.1%	-122.8%	-70.1%	-24.0%	-6.6%	1.4%	7.0%	12.6%	15.6%	18.3%										
NPM	-364.7%	-158.7%	-189.1%	-113.4%	-35.2%	-0.9%	-4.0%	3.7%	8.6%	13.3%	16.3%	19.0%										
R&D spending (Rmb m)	3,614	4,014	3,466	4,132	3,775	2,941	3,015	3,066	3,235	3,397	3,509	3,579										
R&D%	76.9%	105.4%	101.8%	109.5%	75.3%	45.1%	36.0%	32.6%	28.8%	25.3%	22.9%	20.8%										
# of private cloud client (Units)				162	205	329	494	633	744	852	936	1,027										
Private cloud spending (Rmb m)				3.3	3.9	4.6	5.5	4.3	4.8	5.4	7.8	8.2										
# of projects (Units)				28	40	48	55	60	49	61	73	80										
Project size (Rmb m)				20.2	26.2	39.9	37.5	41.6	59.7	57.0	56.1	57.8										
Cash flow																						
CCC	43	42	256	233	145	33	13	33	38	33												
Capex	1,266	5,167	1,518	1,129	1,103	653	419	282	112	107												
Capex to revenues	27%	136%	45%	30%	22%	10%	5%	3%	1%	1%												
Free cash flow	(3,751)	(8,252)	(4,752)	(5,056)	(1,404)	312	(348)	238	1,294	1,878	2,584	3,387	4,064	4,877	5,853	7,023	8,428	10,113	12,136	14,600	17,564	
YoY									443%	45%	38%	31%	20%	20%	20%	20%	20%	20%	20%	20%	20%	
FCF yield	-80%	-217%	-140%	-134%	-28%	5%	-4%	3%	12%	14%	17%	20%									2%	
Terminal growth																						
Terminal value							1.00	0.90	0.80	0.72	0.65	0.58	0.52	0.47	0.42	0.38	0.34	0.30	0.27	0.24	188.527	
Discount factor							(348)	214	1,041	1,355	1,672	1,965	2,115	2,276	2,450	2,636	2,837	3,053	3,286	3,545	3,825	
Present value of FCF																						
Enterprise value 2026E (Rmb m)							72,979															
Cash and equivalents (net)							7,996															
Equity value in 2026E (Rmb m)							80,975															
Value per share (HKD)							2.05															
WACC assumption (2027E)																						
Risk free rate	3.0%																					
Beta	1.90																					
Market risk premium	6.5%																					
Cost of equity	15.4%																					
Cost of debt	4.3%																					
Tax rate	3%																					
Long-run Debt to Asset ratio	34.4%																					
Equity/(debt+equity)	65.6%																					
WACC	11.5%																					

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Sensetime 12M forward P/S



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics

Exhibit 4: Sensetime P&L Summary

Rmb m	1H25	2H25	1H26E	2H26E	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Income statement												
Revenues	2,358	2,656	2,982	3,546	3,406	3,772	5,015	6,527	8,386	9,408	11,241	13,411
GP	908	1,149	1,159	1,372	1,501	1,620	2,056	2,531	3,298	3,788	4,621	5,675
OP	(2,080)	(1,434)	(878)	(689)	(4,295)	(4,630)	(3,514)	(1,567)	(557)	127	792	1,684
EBITDA	(1,443)	(797)	(380)	(190)	(3,210)	(3,344)	(2,282)	(570)	618	1,285	2,007	2,903
Non OP	627	1,228	1,390	110	(2,210)	331	1,854	1,499	212	221	182	143
Pretax income	(1,453)	(206)	511	(579)	(6,504)	(4,300)	(1,660)	(68)	(345)	348	973	1,827
Net income	(1,478)	(288)	516	(575)	(6,440)	(4,278)	(1,766)	(59)	(336)	348	961	1,780
EPS (Rmb)	(0.04)	(0.01)	0.01	(0.01)	(0.20)	(0.13)	(0.05)	(0.00)	(0.01)	0.01	0.02	0.04
Margins												
GM	38.5%	43.2%	38.9%	38.7%	44.1%	42.9%	41.0%	38.8%	39.3%	40.3%	41.1%	42.3%
OPM	-88.2%	-54.0%	-29.5%	-19.4%	-126.1%	-122.8%	-70.1%	-24.0%	-6.6%	1.4%	7.0%	12.6%
Pretax margin	-61.6%	-7.8%	17.1%	-16.3%	-191.0%	-114.0%	-33.1%	-1.0%	-4.1%	3.7%	8.7%	13.6%
EBITDA margin	-61.2%	-30.0%	-12.7%	-5.4%	-94.2%	-88.7%	-45.5%	-8.7%	7.4%	13.7%	17.9%	21.6%
NM	-62.7%	-10.8%	17.3%	-16.2%	-189.1%	-113.4%	-35.2%	-0.9%	-4.0%	3.7%	8.6%	13.3%
YoY												
Revenues	36%	31%	26%	33%	-11%	11%	33%	30%	28%	12%	19%	19%
GP	18%	35%	28%	19%	-41%	8%	27%	23%	30%	15%	22%	23%
OP	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	522%	113%
Pretax income	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	180%	88%
Net income	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	176%	85%
EBITDA	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	108%	56%	45%
HoH												
Revenues	16%	13%	12%	19%								
GP	6%	27%	1%	18%								
OP	na	na	na	na								
Net income	na	na	na	na								

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Sensetime

Valuation: We derive our 12m TP of HK\$2.05, which is derived from a two-stage DCF, where we incorporate a WACC of 11.5% and a terminal growth at 2% YoY. We are Neutral rated on Sensetime.

Key risks: Slower/ Faster-than-expected generative AI customer ramp up pace; Lower/ Higher-than-expected customer spending; Fiercer-/ milder than-expected market competition.

0020.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$2.05	Price: HK\$1.53	Upside: 34.0%
Neutral		GS Forecast	
Market cap: HK\$53.1bn / \$6.8bn Enterprise value: HK\$47.0bn / \$6.0bn 3m ADTV: HK\$701.1mn / \$89.4mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes			
		Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25 12/26E 12/27E 12/28E
		Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	5,014.6 6,527.3 8,386.5 9,407.7
		EBITDA (Rmb mn)	(2,281.9) (570.2) 617.5 1,285.3
		EPS (Rmb) New	(0.05) (0.00) (0.01) 0.01
		EPS (Rmb) Old	(0.05) (0.03) (0.01) 0.01
		P/E (X)	NM NM NM 162.9
		P/B (X)	2.3 2.1 2.1 2.1
		Dividend yield (%)	0.0 0.0 0.0 0.0
		CROCI (%)	(9.4) 4.5 3.7 6.6
		EPS (Rmb)	12/25 6/26E 12/26E 6/27E
			(0.01) 0.01 (0.01) (0.01)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 17 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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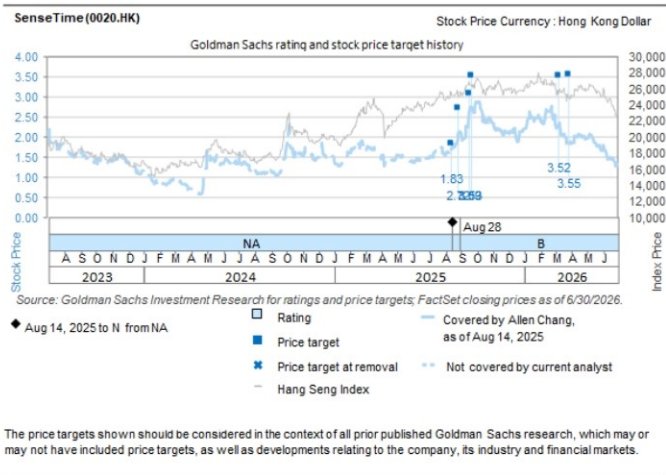
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)
SenseTime (0020.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
06-Aug-26	2.00	1.52
29-Mar-26	3.55	1.86
09-Mar-26	3.52	2.30
21-Sep-25	3.53	2.74
17-Sep-25	3.09	2.64
28-Aug-25	2.72	2.09
14-Aug-25	1.83	1.70

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